

For 100 Black Men of London, I would treat this less as a "membership tracker" and more as a **central CRM + organisational operating system**. The first priority is creating a reliable source of truth about people, relationships, involvement, and engagement.

You are right: **you cannot track new member onboarding properly until you understand your existing ecosystem**. The first phase should be **Member Intelligence & CRM Foundation**.

Phase 1 Goal: Establish the Organisation Database

Core Objective

Create one central database that answers:

- Who are our members?
 - Who are our volunteers?
 - What pillars are they connected to?
 - What teams support them?
 - What programmes have they participated in?
 - What is their current engagement level?
 - How do we move someone from interested → active → leader?
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Top-Level System Structure

1. People (Core CRM)

Everything starts with people.

A single **People** entity rather than separate "Members" and "Volunteers" tables.

Why?

Because someone can be:

- A member
- A volunteer
- A mentor
- A parent
- An alumnus
- A trustee

- A programme participant

People can have multiple roles.

Person Profile

Basic information:

Personal Details

- Full name
- Date of birth
- Gender
- Email
- Phone
- Address
- Emergency contact

Organisation Information

- Person type:
 - Member
 - Volunteer
 - Mentor
 - Alumni
 - Parent
 - Partner
 - Trustee
- Status:
 - Prospect
 - Active
 - Inactive
 - Alumni
 - Left organisation

Engagement

- Date joined
- Last activity date
- Number of programmes attended
- Number of years involved
- Assigned mentor
- Assigned team

Skills / Interests

- Technology
 - Finance
 - Education
 - Leadership
 - Sports
 - Media
 - etc.
-

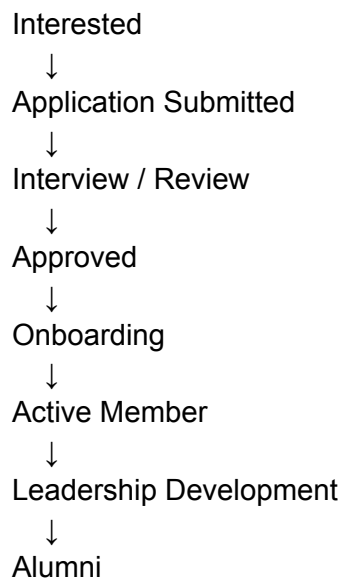
2. Membership Management

This becomes the first major module.

Member Lifecycle

Instead of just storing members, track progression.

Example:



Membership Record

Fields:

Application

- Date applied
- Referral source
- Why they want to join
- Areas of interest

Approval

- Approved by
- Approval date
- Membership type

Engagement

- Last attended event
- Pillars involved
- Teams involved
- Programmes attended

Development

- Leadership pathway
- Skills development
- Mentoring responsibilities

3. Pillars

A person can belong to multiple pillars.

Example:

Leadership

STEM

Health & Wellness

Education

Economic Empowerment

Pillar Structure:

Pillar

|

|---- Pillar Lead
|
|---- Supporting Teams
|
|---- Members
|
|---- Volunteers
|
|---- Programmes

4. Teams

Teams support pillars.

Example:

Leadership Pillar

Teams:

- Mentoring Team
- Events Team
- Communications Team
- Parent Engagement Team

Team Entity:

- Team name
 - Description
 - Lead
 - Members
 - Pillar supported
 - Status
-

5. Programmes

Later, but important.

Examples:

- CMP
- Global Online Youth Mentoring Programme
- MAN UP
- AWS Event
- Graduation Ceremony

Programme:

- Name
 - Pillar
 - Date
 - Location
 - Programme Lead
 - Participants
 - Attendance
 - Outcomes
-

Dashboard (First Version)

The dashboard should answer leadership questions quickly.

Organisation Overview

People

Total People

Members	245
Volunteers	180
Mentors	90
Alumni	300

Membership Health

Membership Status

Active Members	65%
Inactive Members	20%
New Applications	15%

Engagement

Last 90 Days

Events attended

Programme participation

Inactive members

New joiners

Pillar Overview

Example:

Pillar	Members	Volunteer s	Activity
Leadershi p	80	40	High
STEM	45	20	Medium
Health	35	15	Low

Phase 1 MVP Scope

I would NOT build everything initially.

The first release should be:

Module 1: People CRM

CRUD:

- Create Person
 - View Profile
 - Update Person
 - Archive Person
-

Module 2: Membership

CRUD:

- Create Membership
 - Approve Member
 - Change Status
 - Track History
-

Module 3: Pillars

CRUD:

- Create Pillar
 - Assign People
 - Assign Teams
-

Module 4: Dashboard

Basic reporting:

- Total members
 - New members
 - Active/inactive
 - Pillar distribution
 - Recent activity
-

Suggested Database Model (High Level)

People

|
|

Memberships

|
|

Pillars

|
|
Teams
|
|
Programmes
|
|
Attendance
|
|
Activities

Supporting tables:

Roles
Statuses
Skills
Documents
Notes
Communication History

Important Design Decision

Do **not** make:

Members table
Volunteers table
Mentors table

That will create duplication.

Instead:

People

+

Roles

+

Relationships

Example:

John:

Person:

John Smith

Roles:

- ✓ Member
- ✓ Mentor
- ✓ STEM Volunteer

Pillars:

- ✓ STEM
- ✓ Leadership

Teams:

- ✓ STEM Delivery Team
 - ✓ Mentoring Team
-

Future Expansion

Once the foundation exists:

Member Journey Tracking

Example:

New member joins:

System automatically tracks:

Application



Background Checks



Orientation



First Programme



Mentoring Assignment



Leadership Opportunity



Retention

Analytics

Eventually:

- Member retention
 - Volunteer contribution
 - Programme impact
 - Mentor effectiveness
 - Alumni engagement
-

For the first build, I would define it as:

"100BMOL Central CRM — A single source of truth for people, membership, engagement, and organisational growth."

The first milestone should be:

People + Membership + Pillars + Dashboard.

Everything else hangs off that.

This is a much clearer MVP. I would structure it as **Membership CRM Foundation** → **Membership Onboarding Automation**.

The key is: **do not build authentication yet**. Treat email as the temporary identity key and build the system around profiles, workflows, and audit trails.

Phase 1: Membership Dashboard (Foundation)

Before onboarding automation, create the central membership view.

Core Entity: Member Profile

A member record should contain:

Personal Information

- Full name
- Email
- Phone

- Date of birth
- Address
- Gender
- Profile photo (optional)

Membership Information

- Membership status
 - Applicant
 - Pending Review
 - Approved
 - Active
 - Inactive
 - Alumni
- Date joined
- Membership type
- Source (Google Form, manual entry)

Organisation Links

- Pillars
- Teams
- Roles
 - Member
 - Mentor
 - Volunteer
 - Alumni

Onboarding Status

Example:

Application

✓ Received

Welcome Email

✓ Sent

Checklist

✓ Sent

Documents

2/5 completed

Onboarding
60%

Phase 2: New Member Flow

High Level Flow

Google Form Submitted



System receives submission



Create Applicant Profile



Send Welcome Email



Wait X Days



Send Checklist Email



Member uploads documents



Documents linked to profile



Membership team reviews



Activate Member

Step 1: Google Form Integration

Google Form remains the front door.

When submitted:

System receives:

Name:

John Smith

Email:

john@email.com

Phone:

xxxx

Application Date:

01/08/2026

System checks:

Does email already exist?

YES:

Update existing profile

NO:

Create new profile

Then:

Member Status:

Applicant

Onboarding Status:

Started

Step 2: Welcome Email Automation

Immediately after creation:

Email:

Welcome to 100 Black Men of London. We have received your application and will guide you through the next steps.

System records:

Communication Log

01 Aug 2026

Welcome email sent

Status:

Delivered

Step 3: Checklist Automation

Configurable delay.

Example:

Admin setting:

New Member Checklist Delay

[2] Days

After 2 days:

System sends:

Please complete your onboarding checklist.

Checklist could include:

- ☐ Upload passport/photo ID
- ☐ Upload DBS certificate
- ☐ Upload qualification certificates
- ☐ Complete member profile

☐ Attend induction

Step 4: Document Upload System

This is a good approach.

No login required.

Each member receives a unique upload link:

Example:

100bmol.org/upload-documents/abc123

The page asks:

Email:

Document Type:
[DBS Certificate]

Upload File:
[Choose File]

Submit

Important: Do not trust email alone

Email matching is useful but mistakes happen.

The system should have a **Document Inbox**.

Document Upload Table

Every upload creates a record:

Document Upload

ID:
DOC-10023

Uploaded Email:
john@gmal.com

Document:
DBS Certificate

File:
john-dbs.pdf

Uploaded:
05 Aug 2026

Status:
Pending Matching

Matching Logic

When uploaded:

System checks:

Does email exist?

YES

|

Attach document to member

NO

|

Create unmatched document record

Notify admin

Admin Document Review Queue

Dashboard:

Documents Awaiting Review

12 files

Example:

Uploaded Email:

john@gmail.com

Suggested Match:

John Smith

john@gmail.com

[Confirm Match]

[Create New Profile]

[Reject]

Google Drive Integration

Google Drive becomes storage.

CRM stores metadata.

Example:

CRM:

Document ID

DOC-10023

Member:

John Smith

Type:

DBS Certificate

Drive URL:

<https://drive.google.com/...>

Uploaded:

05 Aug 2026

Google Drive:

100BMOL CRM/

Members/

John Smith/

DBS Certificate.pdf

Passport.pdf

Document Requirements Setup

Do not hard-code documents.

Create configurable requirements:

Example:

Member Onboarding Documents

Document	Required
DBS Certificate	Yes
Photo ID	Yes
Passport Photo	Yes
Qualification Certificate	Optional

Then later:

Volunteer onboarding may have different requirements.

Dashboard (First Version)

Leadership view:

Membership Overview

Total Members

1,240

Active Members

860

Pending Applications

42

Awaiting Documents

85

Incomplete Profiles

130

Onboarding Funnel

Applications Received

100

Welcome Sent

100

Checklist Sent

90

Documents Complete

65

Fully Active

50

Technical Modules

I would define the first build as:

Module 1

Membership CRM

- Members
- Profiles
- Status
- Roles
- Pillars

Module 2

Application Integration

- Google Form webhook/API
- Import submissions
- Create profiles

Module 3

Workflow Engine

- Email triggers
- Delays
- Tasks

Module 4

Document Management

- Upload portal
- Google Drive integration
- Document matching
- Audit logs

The biggest architectural decision is this:

The Member Profile is the centre of everything.

Applications, documents, emails, programmes, pillars and teams all attach to the member profile.

That gives 100BMOL a proper organisational memory instead of disconnected spreadsheets and forms.